The Memory Cycle Journal

US THURSDAY — HUANG RESIGNS
Nvidia −4.34% $166.19 after opening −13.1%; Micron $798.44 −1.59% · Sandisk $937.46 −4.11% · SOX 10,506.67 −0.54% · Nvidia, Reuters

KOREA FRIDAY — CLOSE · DRAM SPOT
KOSPI 5,290.54 −0.98%; Samsung ₩206,000 −0.96% · SK hynix ₩1,216,000 −3.03% · DDR5 16Gb $60.233 (flat) · KRX via Naver, TrendForce

LEAD STORY

NVIDIA · HBM · MARKETS

Jensen Huang Quits Nvidia, and the Memory Question Becomes Who Gets the HBM

Nvidia's board accepted Huang's resignation; CFO Colette Kress is interim CEO. Nvidia fell 4.3% and Micron 1.6%. Samsung told BofA it has seen no order cuts, and analysts say Nvidia's discounted HBM terms may not outlast him. Seoul opened up 2–3% and then turned lower.

By the Memory Cycle Desk · Tel Aviv · ~08:40 IST Friday (UTC+2) · Korea = final close · US = Thursday close · Spot TrendForce Nov 13 11:00 GMT+8 · CONFIRMED unless marked

KEY NUMBERS · KOREA FRIDAY CLOSE · US THURSDAY CLOSE · SPOT FRIDAY

KOREA, FRIDAY CLOSE		US, THURSDAY CLOSE	
KOSPI	**5,290.54 (−0.98%)**	Micron	**$798.44 (−1.59%)**
Samsung	**₩206,000 (−0.96%)**	Sandisk	**$937.46 (−4.11%)**
SK hynix	**₩1,216,000 (−3.03%)**	SK hynix ADR	**−3.19%**
DDR5 16Gb spot	**$60.23 (0.00%)**	SOX	**10,506.67 (−0.54%)**
DDR4 16Gb spot	**$79.50 (−0.31%)**	Nvidia	**$166.19 (−4.34%)**

What this shows: the market priced a leadership shock, not a demand shock. Nvidia recovered from −13.1% at the open; AMD (+5.86%) and Broadcom (+5.54%) rose. Memory stocks slipped. DDR5 spot was flat for a third session; DDR4 kept easing. NAND wafer spot ($16.15) is still the Nov 2 print. Sources: Nvidia, Reuters via Investing.com, Yahoo Finance, KRX via Naver Finance, Herald Business, TrendForce.

Nvidia said its board had accepted Huang's resignation as president, chief executive and director, effective immediately. Kress stays CFO while the board searches inside and outside the company, and director Harvey Jones becomes Nvidia's first board chair. The company said customer commitments and the product roadmap continue without interruption; it reports fiscal third-quarter results on Nov. 17 as scheduled. Reuters, citing supply-chain sources, said the chips Nvidia ships over the next year or two are already designed and in production. Huang has agreed to testify before Congress before Thanksgiving, and the Justice Department is reported to be examining Nvidia on antitrust grounds REPORTED.

For memory, the open question is pricing power. SemiAnalysis estimates SK hynix's 2027 HBM4 price at roughly $3.0–3.3 per gigabit for Nvidia versus $3.7–4.1 for AMD, Broadcom, Amazon and Google, and expects Nvidia's preferential access to weaken without Huang. "If another company fills the gap left by Nvidia, it will still need our HBM," the Korea Semiconductor Industry Association's Ahn Ki-hyun told The Korea Herald. Samsung told BofA it has seen no order cuts tied to a slowdown in US data-center

building, and Cerebras's CEO expects memory shortages and price increases to run through 2028 (both via X). In Seoul, the KOSPI opened 2.05% higher and briefly topped 5,500 before foreign investors turned net sellers; it closed at 5,290.54 (−0.98%). Samsung closed at ₩206,000 (−0.96%) and SK hynix at ₩1,216,000 (−3.03%).

Our call: late upcycle; tight through 2027 / into 2028. Unchanged overall: supply a touch tighter, demand quality still the risk. CYCLE SIGNAL: SUPPLY TIGHTER, PRICING POWER SHIFTING TO MEMORY

EQUIPMENT · SUPPLY

Applied Materials Beats as China's SMIC Says Memory Won't Balance Until Mid-to-Late 2028

Applied Materials' fiscal fourth-quarter revenue rose 53% to $10.41 billion, ahead of the $10.30 billion consensus, and it guided the January quarter to about $11.10 billion against $10.89 billion expected (Reuters). Shares rose about 3% after hours. SMIC posted record third-quarter revenue of $3.19 billion (+33.9%) and 97.3% utilization. Co-CEO Zhao Haijun said capacity stays severely constrained through 2027 and shortages may extend into mid-to-late 2028; AI-related memory supply and demand could reach a rough balance after mid-2028. He said suppliers now quote 16–24 months for new equipment orders (TrendForce, citing IT Home and Cailian Press). TrendForce also reported that TSMC, which denied plans to make 3D DRAM, is involved in HBM base dies and wafer-to-wafer stacking.

POLICY · CHINA · DEALS

Senator Asks Commerce to Blacklist CXMT as Samsung Weighs a Data-Center Cooling Deal

Sen. Tom Cotton asked Commerce Secretary Howard Lutnick to add CXMT to the Entity List, cutting it off from US tools and technical support for all its fabs, and to explore banning its products from the US market (CNBC, Reuters). Counterpoint data cited by CNBC put CXMT at 10% of DRAM revenue in 2Q26, up from 4% a year earlier. Cotton's letter says CXMT's HBM3E yields hover around 20%. Commerce has not said whether it will act; separately, Reuters reported the White House is discussing Lutnick's future REPORTED. Samsung is in talks to buy US data-center cooling maker Modine, valued at about $5.6 billion, Bloomberg reported; Modine rose about 29% after hours and neither company commented UNCONFIRMED.

FROM THE INBOX · SINCE THU ~08:00 IST · READ-ONLY

NEW **A record DRAM quarter at Applied.** October-quarter DRAM sales were a record $2.64bn (+44% q/q) and NAND $720m (+46%). Management sees 2027 equipment spending up about 30%; Goldman models about +45%. Cleanroom space is the gating factor. Jefferies, Goldman Sachs (Nov 12)

NEW **Nvidia without Huang: earnings hold, multiple doesn't.** Backlog runs 12–24 months, so 12–18-month earnings impact is limited; the bigger hit is to the multiple. Goldman Sachs (Nov 12)

SUPPLY CHAIN **No spare capacity to switch to.** UBS: even if customers wanted to swap Nvidia GPUs for AMD's, they can't soon, with no spare substrate or capacity. Nvidia may lose supplier relationships that let it buy cheaper parts, "particularly memory." TMT Breakout EOD wrap (Nov 12)

ON X · SINCE THU ~08:00 · IST

@pequityresearch · Nov 13 02:42
Samsung told BofA in an investor meeting it has seen no order cuts tied to concerns about a post-midterm US data-center slowdown.
x.com/.../2121040870325817790

@pequityresearch · Nov 13 05:45
Cerebras CEO Andrew Feldman expects memory shortages and price increases to continue through 2028.
x.com/.../2121086963847495766

@pequityresearch · Nov 12 20:51
Citing SemiAnalysis: Nvidia's HBM4 pricing is roughly 19–20% below Google, Amazon, AMD and Broadcom; "it will look different with someone else going to Korea."
x.com/.../2120952627911663968

@pequityresearch · Nov 12 18:00
Morgan Stanley: Google TPUs ~35% of global HBM demand vs Nvidia 36%; AMD 16%, AWS 5%.
x.com/.../2120909493538021435

@jukan05 · Nov 12 10:39
Says Rubin is delayed again by motherboard warpage (HBM issue fixed in October); volume shipments slip to 2027 and Nvidia raised Blackwell orders. UNCONFIRMED
x.com/.../2120798532177125572

@wallstengine · Nov 13 01:49
Samsung in talks to buy data-center cooling maker Modine, per Bloomberg. UNCONFIRMED
x.com/.../2121027639997866089

CYCLE TRACKER · SUPPLY A TOUCH TIGHTER; DEMAND QUALITY STILL THE RISK

GAUGE	TODAY VS NOV 12 (KPI WATCH LIST)	NUDGE
Contract ROC	No new contract data. Enterprise DRAM/SSD hikes still verbal, no formal letters; PC DRAM 4Q26 +13–18%, eSSD +15–20% (TrendForce)	**Rising, unchanged**
Spot vs contract	DDR5 16Gb $60.233 flat for a third session; DDR4 16Gb $79.50 (−0.31%), 8Gb $44.54 (−0.40%). NAND wafer print still Nov 2	**Flat / DDR4 easing**
Inventory / demand	Samsung: no order cuts (BofA). Cerebras: shortages through 2028. Nvidia CEO exit; Rubin slip to 2027 (unconfirmed). Nebius 2027 capex $40–45bn	**Amber, steady**
Supply growth / capex	AMAT record DRAM quarter; 2027 WFE ~+30%. SMIC: memory balance only mid-to-late 2028; tool lead times 16–24 months. Push to blacklist CXMT (10% of DRAM)	**Tighter**
Valuation	MU −1.59%, SNDK −4.11%, NVDA −4.34% Thursday; KOSPI gave up a 3% opening gain Friday	**Volatile**

VERDICT VS PREVIOUS CALL (NO. 37, NOV 12)
Late upcycle; tight through 2027 and into 2028. Unchanged overall. Supply a touch tighter: SMIC sees memory balance only after mid-2028, equipment lead times are 16–24 months, and a senator wants CXMT blacklisted. Demand holds (Samsung no order cuts, AMAT record DRAM tools, Cerebras shortages through 2028), but Huang's exit raises demand-quality and financing risk while shifting HBM pricing power toward suppliers. Prices unchanged: DDR5 spot flat, DDR4 easing. Top playbook signal (DDR5 spot falling while contract rises) has not appeared.

EVENTS CALENDAR · NOV 13–DEC 3 · ISRAEL TIME (IST, UTC+2) · US CASH OPEN 16:30

Fri Nov 13	US PPI (October) 15:30	Macro
Tue Nov 17	Nvidia FQ3, first under interim CEO Kress (release ~23:20, call 00:00 Nov 18) · SC26 Nov 17–19	HBM
Nov 18–20	Anthropic IPO pricing (18th), listing (19th) · Trump at APEC Shenzhen (18–19) · Sandisk 8-for-1 split, split-adjusted trading from Nov 20	NAND

Nov 23–26	Korea Nov 1–20 exports (~23rd) · US PCE (25th) · Huang testimony due before Thanksgiving (26th)	Exports
Nov 30–Dec 3	TrendForce month-end contract prices · House interviews of Huang (Dec 1) and Nvidia's general counsel (Dec 2); Commerce export-control hearing (Dec 3)	Policy

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Unconfirmed reports are labeled as such. Figures are only those cited from named sources. · Edition #38 · Nov 13, 2026